

PORTFOLIO 26/27

Murat Kurul

Apparel & Product Design

London, United Kingdom
Open to relocate

murat338338@gmail.com
muratkurul.com



About me ✨

I'm a London-based designer who trained in industrial design at Loughborough and spent a year in-house at **Contex Textile** in Istanbul, around garment sourcing, sampling and buyer presentations. I played **BUCS basketball** for two years and wrote my dissertation on how what players wear shapes their confidence and identity on court. That's where I want to design: where sport, culture and everyday style meet.

HOW I WORK

01

Consumer

Who is it for, and where do they wear it?

02

Insight

Research, trends and market into one clear opportunity

03

Story

Narrative, moodboard, colour and material

04

Product

Sketches, flats, construction and fit

05

Handover

Specs, feedback rounds, clear presentation

TOOLS

Illustrator, Photoshop, InDesign, Procreate, Figma, SolidWorks, Rhino, KeyShot, PowerPoint, Excel

LANGUAGES

English, Turkish (fluent)

LOCATION

London · open to relocate

OFF THE CLOCK

Basketball, gym, climbing, hiking, and AI as a daily tool for concepts and workflow

Contents *

Apparel first, then the product and research work behind it.

01	AERØ	Sport product, brand & go-to-market	04
02	Liman	My own label · oversized summer essentials from İzmir	07
03	Night Court	Concept capsule · streetball and traditional Chinese details	17
04	Anatude	Modular outdoor apparel system	24
05	Consumer Insight	Dissertation · basketball, confidence & identity	26
06	Industry	Contex Textile · garment sampling & presentation	27
07	More Work	Fresha, Postura, jewellery, product	28



A portable, battery-powered shoe dryer for athletes, designed to cut moisture and odour wherever they train. I took it from user research to a working prototype and a complete brand, including packaging, retail and a campaign.

Project 01 · Final year

Duration: 10 weeks

Type: Product & brand design



Relevant here: designing for a sport consumer, CMF choices and taking a product all the way to shelf.



AERØ X PURESORT

A COMMUNITY RUN
FOCUSED ON
PERFORMANCE AND
RECOVERY — POWERED
BY AERØ AND
PURESORT.

10K RUN + RECOVERY SESSION

**21 JUNE
2026**

**HYDE PARK,
LONDON,
ENGLAND**

JOIN THE RUN

+44

BUYAERO.COM

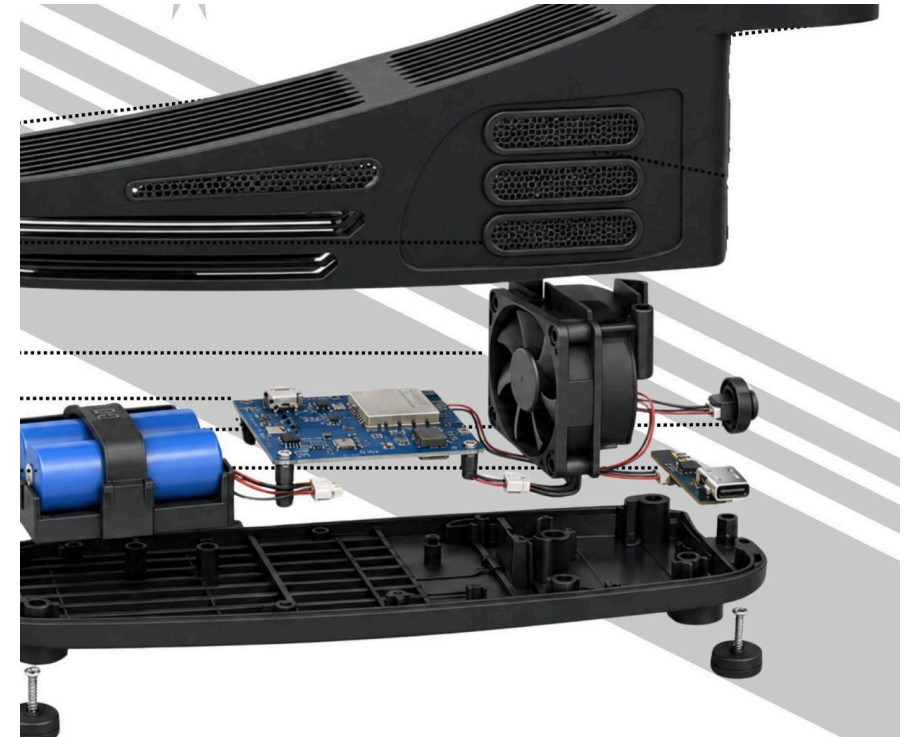
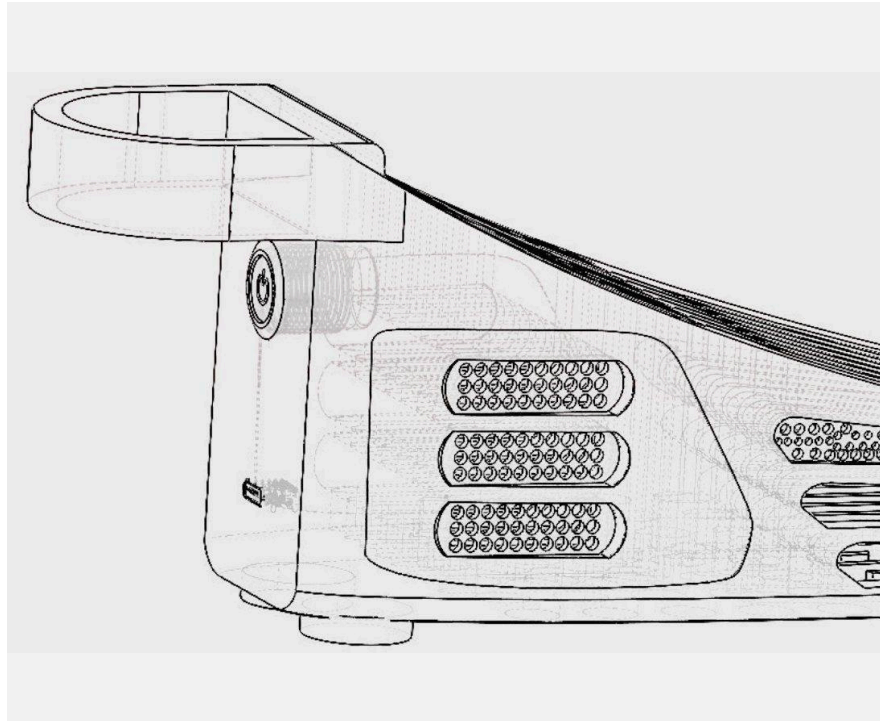


AERØ · BRAND & GO-TO-MARKET

Drying, Redesigned.

Logo, tone of voice, packaging, a sports-retail shelf and a co-branded 10K run + recovery event. The product only works if the athlete meets it in the right place.

Sketch, CAD, print, test, refine



Test early

Early concepts went to target users before any CAD.

Build it properly

External form and internal parts modelled in SolidWorks.

Feedback into the next round

Printed prototype tested again by athletes, then refined.

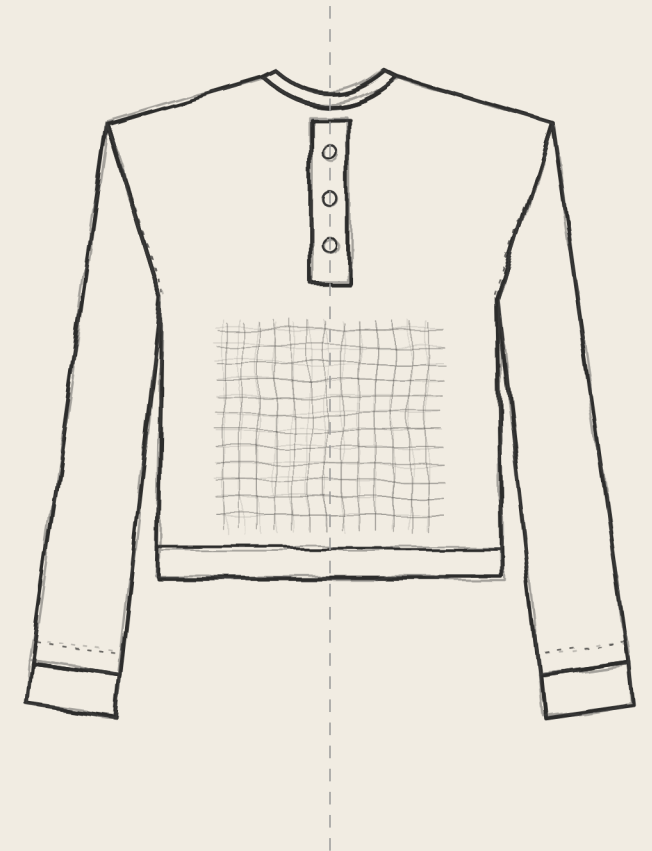
Liman

Liman means harbour in Turkish. It's based in İzmir, where I spent my childhood summers on the coast, surrounded by olive trees. The label takes that feeling and turns it into cropped, boxy essentials with sun-faded colour and hand-drawn graphics.

Type: Brand + capsule, self-initiated

Drop: First Summer, 5 pieces

Year: 2026



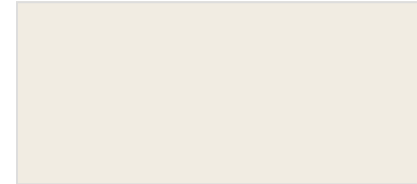
cropped. boxy. made for long summers.

A brand that feels hand-made



Script wordmark for product and graphics, loose and quick like a signature. **Olive tree** as the small mark for labels, buttons and social, drawn from the olive groves along the İzmir coast. **Serif lockup** for packaging and anything that needs to feel calm.

COLOUR



Limewash

#F1ECE2 · Whitewashed village walls



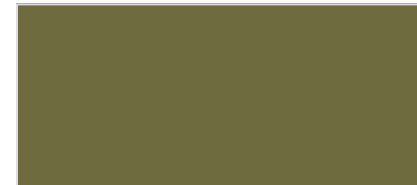
Aegean Navy

#1F2B3B · The sea at night, base colour



Terracotta

#B5532E · Roof tiles, hero accent



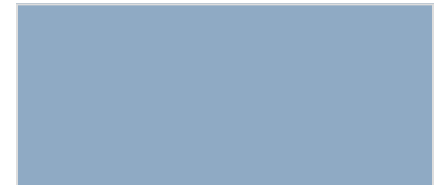
Olive

#6E6C3E · Olive groves, accent



Sand

#D8C7A6 · Beach and linen, neutral



Awning Blue

#8FAAC4 · Faded beach umbrellas

TYPE & VOICE

Long summers

Caveat Brush · graphics

İzmir · Türkiye

Instrument Serif · editorial

Voice: short, warm, a bit dry. Never shouty. "See you at the harbour."



LIMAN · CAMPAIGN POSTER

One leaf, repeated until it becomes a tree.

The poster is built from a single olive leaf mark, placed thousands of times on a grid and turned by a made-up sea breeze. Where the leaves crowd, the tree appears. The trunk is drawn with fine twisting lines, the way old olive trunks on the Aegean coast look like they've been wrung out.

Text stays tiny and low, like a label sewn into a hem. The same leaf is used on tags, prints and social, so the whole brand speaks one visual language.



The one who packs light.

20 to 30, lives in a city but plans the year around summer. Five-a-side on Tuesdays, a flight to the Aegean in June, dinners that run late under the olive trees. Wants a small wardrobe that looks considered without trying, and buys fewer, better pieces.

- RELAXED
- SUN-FADED
- HAND-DRAWN
- CONSIDERED
- SPORTY

THE IDEA

One block, cut shorter and wider, across every top in the range.

01

Cropped hits the belt
Works with high, pleated trousers and wide shorts, the way people wear them now.

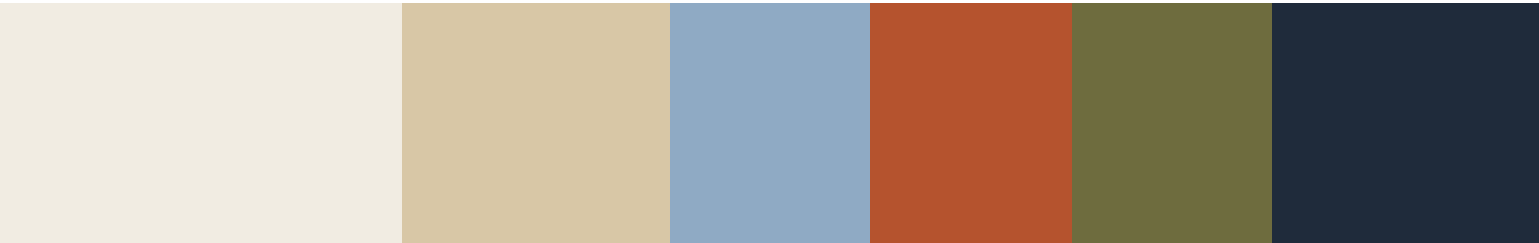
02

Boxy means room
Dropped shoulder and wide elbow sleeves for heat, movement and an easy drape.

03

Sport meets tailoring
A waffle henley from training kit and a stripe shirt from the holiday, cut from the same block.

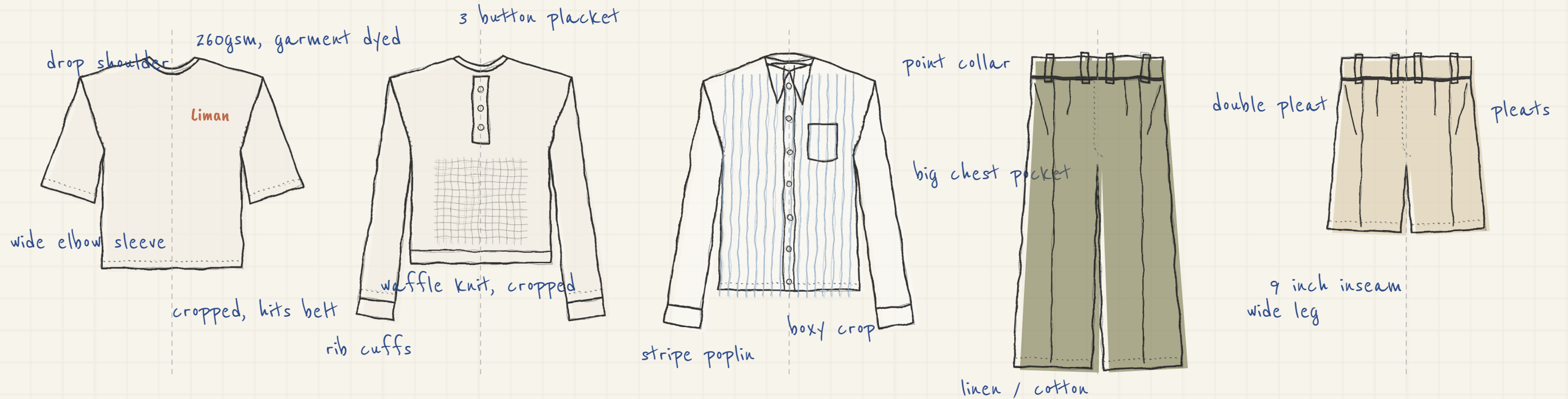
COLOUR TAKEN FROM THE İZMİR COAST



Limewash walls · sand · faded umbrellas · roof tiles · olive trees · the sea at night

First Summer, rough

everything from one cropped block →



LIMAN · LINE-UP

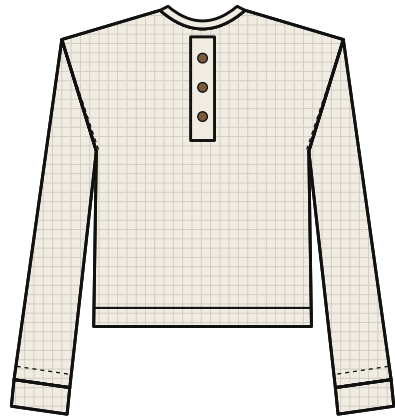
First Summer drop

Liman



Boxy Crop Tee

260gsm jersey · garment dyed



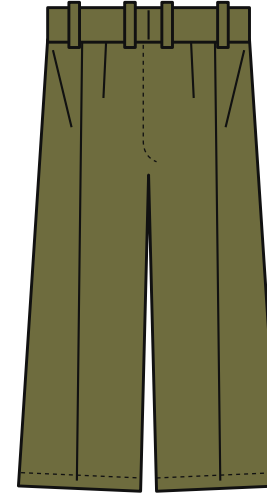
Waffle Henley

Cotton waffle · 3 button placket · cropped



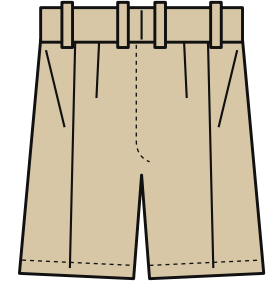
Awning Stripe Shirt

Poplin · point collar · cropped



Double Pleat Trouser

Linen-cotton · wide leg



Pleated Short

Linen-cotton · 9in inseam

Liman





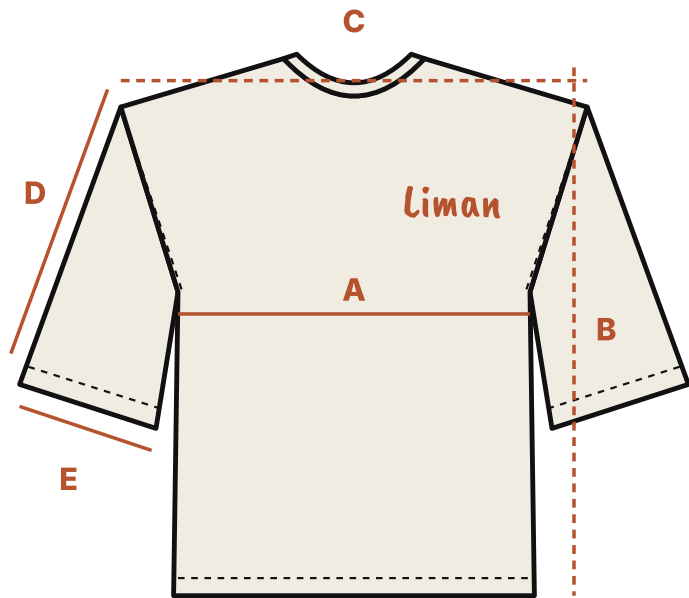
LIMAN · LOOKBOOK

Oversized, not sloppy.

Big, square tops cropped at the belt and very wide pleated trousers. The proportion takes cues from SGO and Represent, the line art from Aimé Leon Dore, softened with Aegean colour and an olive tree drawn by hand on the back.

see you at the harbour

Boxy Crop Tee, spec



FRONT



BACK · HAND-DRAWN OLIVE TREE PRINT

	SIZE M, CM	STANDARD TEE	LIMAN
A	Chest width	52	62
B	Body length (HPS)	72	64
C	Shoulder width	46	60
D	Sleeve length	20	24
E	Sleeve opening	17	22

8cm shorter and 10cm wider than a standard tee, so it sits at the belt and drapes square.

COLOURWAYS



Limewash · Navy · Terracotta · Olive

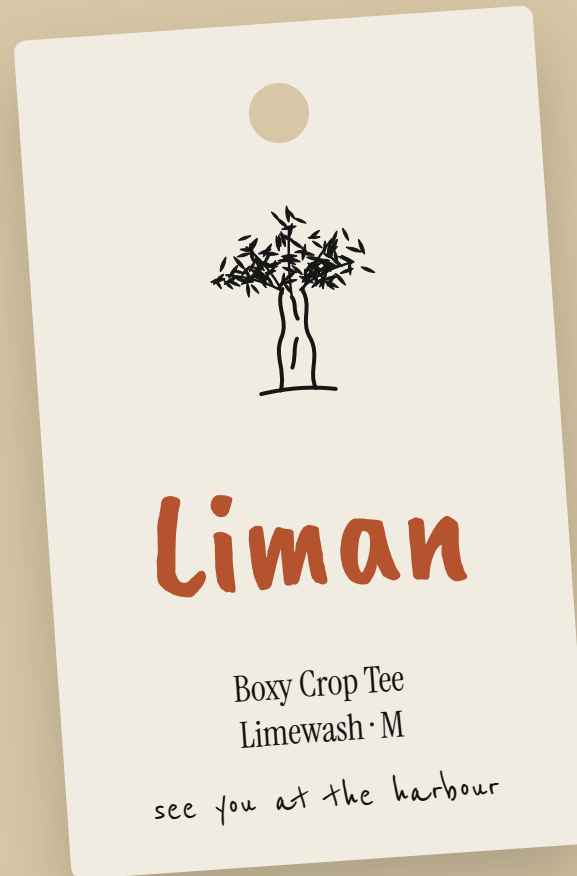
Labels, tags, packaging



Woven neck label



Care / size tab



Swing tag



Recycled mailer box with a single-colour print

夜间球场

yèjiān qiúchǎng

Night Court

A unisex capsule for young Shanghai players who go from a late pickup game straight into the city. It mixes basketball warm-up wear with details from traditional Chinese dress: stand collars, offset fronts and pankou knot closures, reworked so they actually work as sportswear.

Type: Apparel concept, mini design story

Status: In development

Year: 2026

HERO: PANKOU WARM-UP JACKET





NIGHT COURT · IN CONTEXT

11pm, under the floodlights.

The hero jacket on court. Tricot that moves like warm-up wear, a stand collar and offset front from traditional dress, and gold pankou knots that actually close the jacket.

Why visualise it

Seeing the piece on a real body in its real setting is the fastest way to test whether the story works before spending on a sample.

Who it's for

CONSUMER

The court-to-city player, 18–25

Lives in Shanghai, plays pickup after class or work, then walks the city with friends. Wants one outfit that works on court and on the street. Proud of Chinese culture and wears it with confidence, not as costume. Buys into heritage sportswear, but wants it to feel local.

Their need

Pieces that move like sportswear, look sharp at 11pm on the street, and say something about where they're from.

01

Heritage worn every day

Young shoppers in China are wearing traditional details like stand collars and frog buttons in relaxed, everyday cuts. It has grown since around 2021 and now shows up on global runways too.

02

The frog button went viral

In 2026 a track jacket with pankou buttons became a global talking point. One video of it passed 9.5M views. A single cultural detail on a sport classic carried the whole product.

03

City walk culture

Gen Z treat walking the city as a social activity. Clothes need to go from activity to hanging out without a change.

OPPORTUNITY

Take the pankou idea beyond one jacket and build a full court-to-city story around basketball warm-up wear.

Court lights, old buttons, late streets.

The story starts at 11pm under floodlights and ends on a walk home through the city. Every piece keeps a basketball base (mesh, tricot, ribbing) and carries one clear Chinese detail that also does a job: a knot that closes, a slit that frees the stride, a cross-over that layers.

盘扣 · 立领 · 开衩 · 大襟

Frog knot · stand collar · side slit · cross-over front

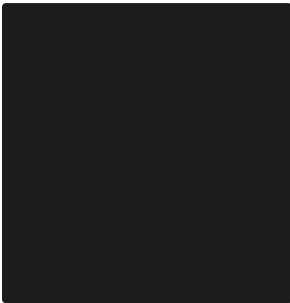
COLOUR



Lacquer Red

#A8261E

Hero colour, energy, celebration



Ink Black

#1C1C1E

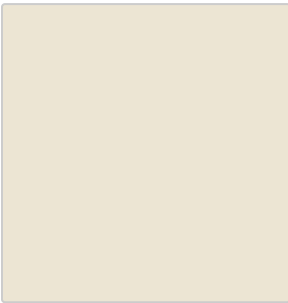
Night, court lines, base



Jade

#3F7A68

Calm, heritage, secondary



Rice Paper

#ECE5D3

Light, everyday, neutral



Gold Thread

#C49A3E

Knots, trims, details only

MATERIAL & TRIM DIRECTION

MATERIAL	USE	WHY
Recycled poly tricot	Jacket, track pant	Classic track handle, soft sheen under lights
Recycled poly mesh	Shorts, jacket lining	Breathability on court
Heavyweight cotton jersey	Shooting shirt	Boxy drape, takes print well
Nylon ripstop + light padding	Quilted vest	Warmth for cold night walks, packs small
Cord knot + moulded toggle	Pankou closures	Hand-feel of a frog knot, sports-grade function

Five pieces, one story

UNISEX · RELAXED FIT



Pankou Warm-Up Jacket

Tricot · stand collar · offset zip + knot closures



Cropped Shooting Shirt

Heavy jersey · boxy crop · wide sleeve



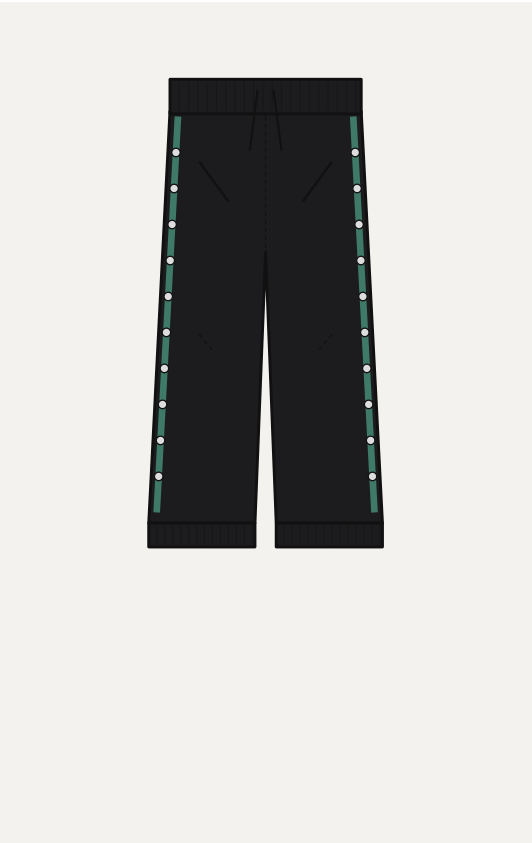
Cross-Over Quilt Vest

Ripstop · cross-over (dajin) front · snaps



Slit Court Short

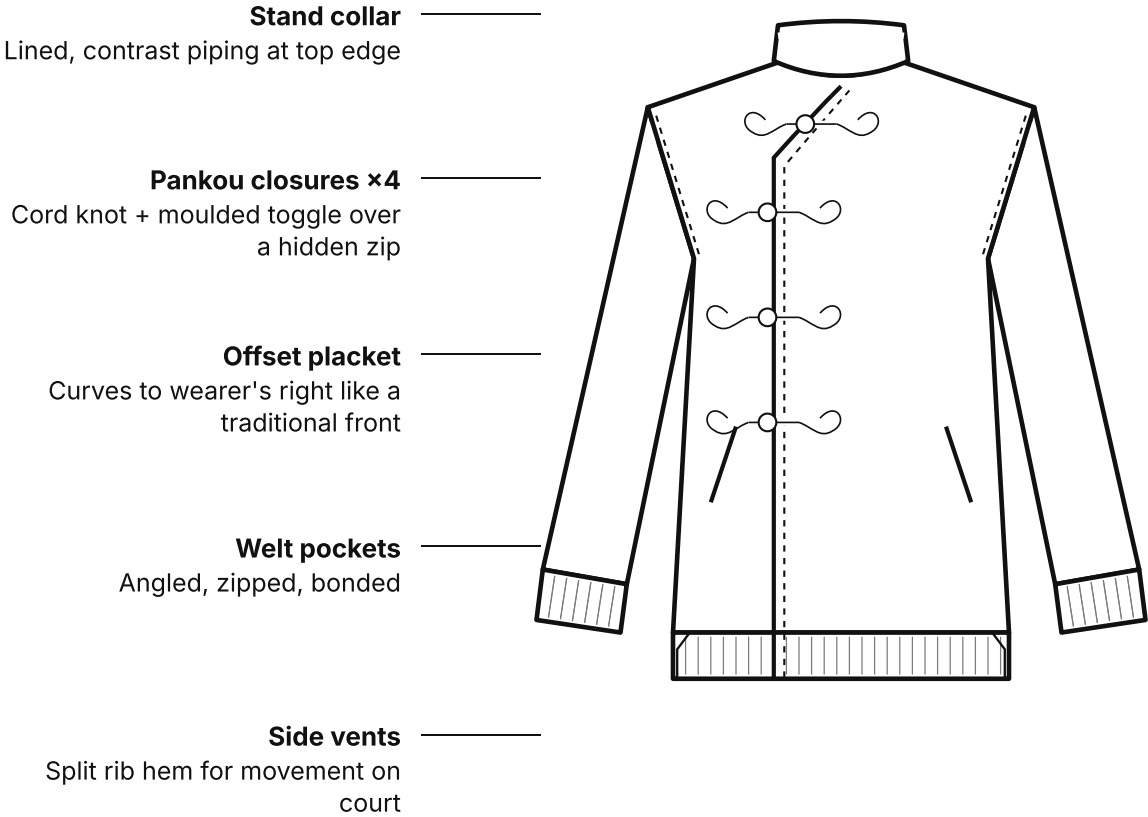
Mesh · curved side slits · contrast binding



Snap Track Pant

Tricot · side snaps · ribbed cuff

Pankou Warm-Up Jacket



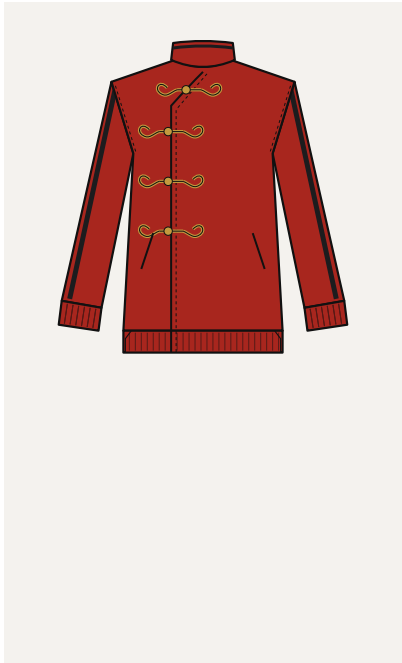
FRONT



BACK

SHELL	LINING	TRIMS	FIT	SIZE RANGE	OPEN QUESTIONS FOR DEVELOPMENT
Recycled poly tricot	Poly mesh	Cord knots, toggles, concealed zip, piping tape	Relaxed, dropped shoulder	XS–2XL unisex	Knot durability in wash · toggle cost vs. stitched knot

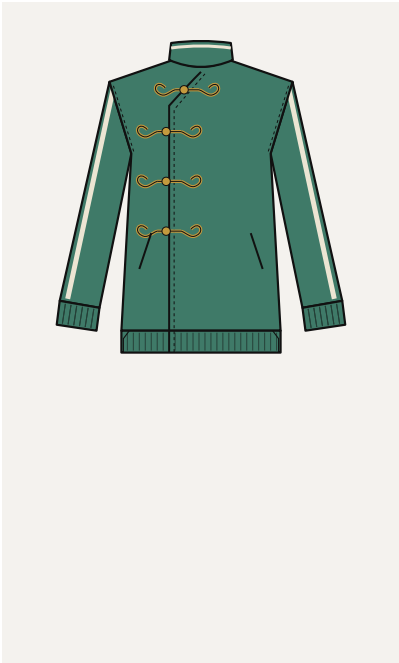
Commercial thinking



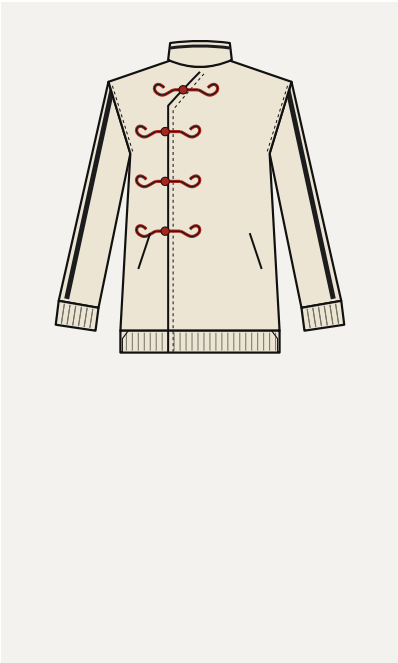
Lacquer Red
Hero / launch



Ink Black
Core, all year



Jade
Seasonal



Rice Paper
Seasonal, light

RANGE PLAN

PIECE	ROLE	TIER
Pankou Jacket	Hero, story carrier	Elevated
Quilt Vest	Layering, cold season	Elevated
Track Pant	Pairs with jacket	Core
Court Short	Volume, summer	Core
Shooting Shirt	Entry price, graphic	Entry

Trade-offs I'd raise early

Real knots cost more than a zip, so knots stay on the hero and vest only. Black carries volume; red is the launch story. One graphic family across shirt and jacket back keeps artwork costs down.

Next step: sample the hero jacket, test knot durability, and fit on both men's and women's bodies before confirming the size range.

ANATUDE

A modular clothing system that keeps climbers warm, mobile and comfortable as conditions change at altitude. Inspired by the **Annapurna range** and the **Himalayan Monal**, its layers and vents let the wearer adjust protection through the climb.

DESIGN FOCUS

- Layering system: shell, mid layer, base
- Zip-off and vented panels for temperature control
- Colour story pulled from the bird's plumage
- Line-up sketches and detail call-outs



Project 04

Type: Apparel system, personal project



ANATUDE · MOODBOARD TO PRODUCT

From a bird to a system

I built the moodboard around the Monal's iridescent colour shifts and the textures of snow and rock, then translated them into gradient prints and blocked panels. Technical outdoor references set the function; the bird set the attitude.

What I'd push next

Technical flats for each layer, a fabric and trim list, and a toned-down colourway for a wider, more commercial customer.



Palette taken from the Himalayan Monal

What players wear changes how they play.

I asked how the look and feel of basketball footwear affects players' perceived confidence, identity and performance. As a BUCS player myself, I could talk to athletes as a teammate, not an outsider.

8

BUCS players

University-level basketball players interviewed

1:1

Semi-structured

Open conversations around set themes

TA

Thematic analysis

Coding transcripts into recurring themes

HOW THIS SHAPES MY DESIGN WORK

- Start with the athlete's own words, then design. Not the other way round.
- Aesthetics are functional: how a product looks affects how confident someone feels in it.
- Identity matters as much as performance, which is exactly why Night Court leads with culture.

Contex Textile

Product Design Development Intern
Istanbul · Jun 2025 – Jun 2026

A year in-house at a garment manufacturer and its London sister company, Conuk Ltd. I saw how a garment really gets made: the back-and-forth with suppliers, sample rounds, specs and the presentation that wins the order.

The ranges I worked on are confidential, so no product images are shown.

THE PROCESS I SUPPORTED

01

Brief

Range direction from the customer

02

Sourcing

Working with suppliers on fabric and trims

03

Sampling

Following samples between factory and team

04

Specs

Supporting specifications for production

05

Presentation

Brand materials for buyer meetings

What it taught me

Creative intent always meets cost, lead time and factory capability. Raising issues early saves a sample round.

Also delivered

A redesign of the Conuk Ltd website in Figma, and a consistent visual identity across both companies' buyer materials.

WHAT I'D BRING TO AN APPAREL DESIGN TEAM

SAMPLE REVIEW

SUPPLIER & FACTORY COMMUNICATION

SPEC ACCURACY

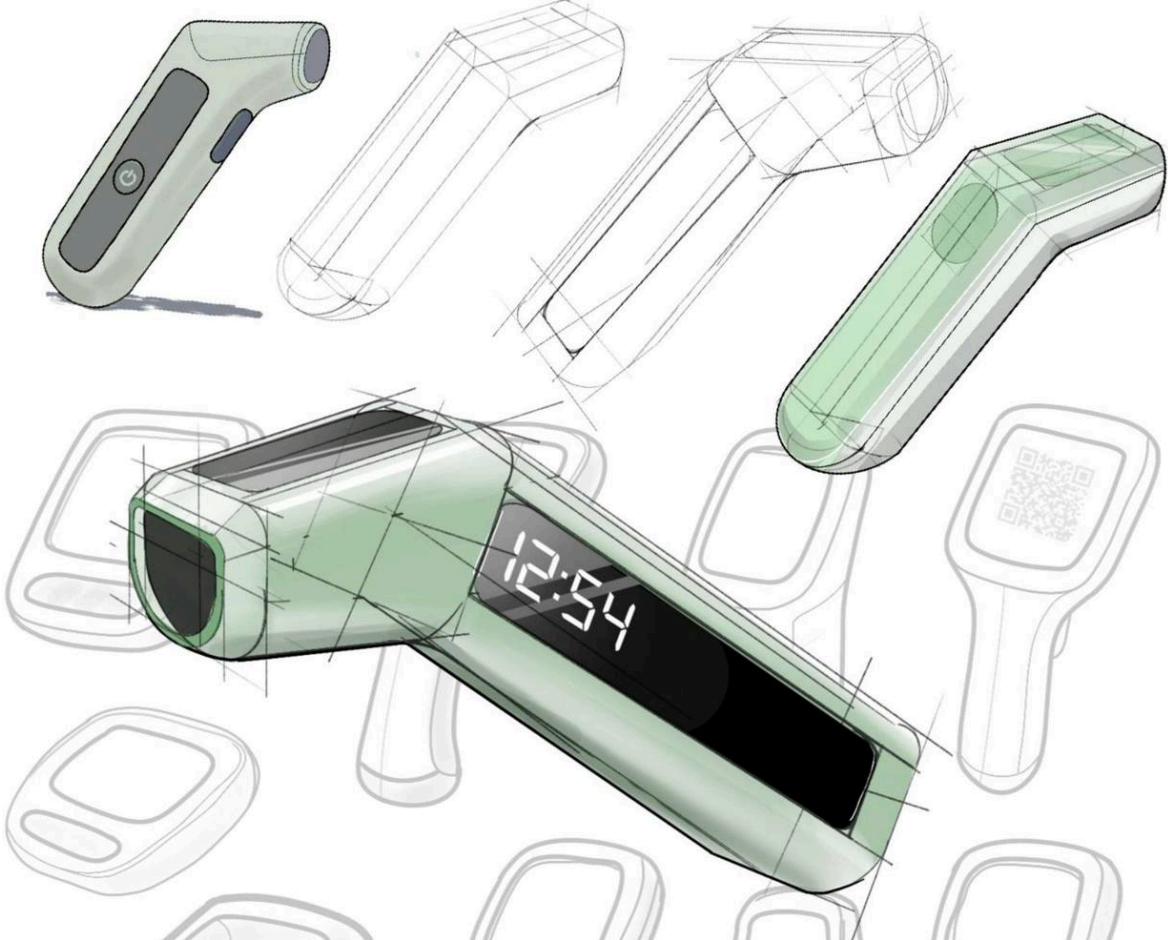
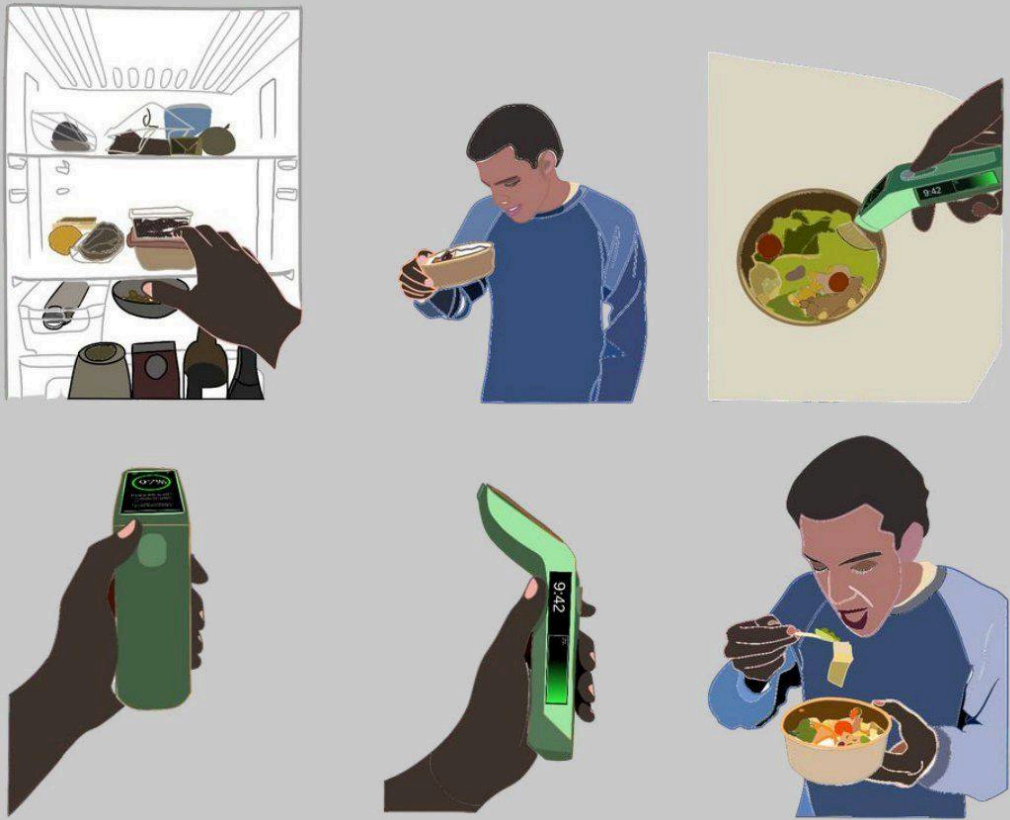
COST VS. CREATIVE TRADE-OFFS

BUYER-READY PRESENTATION

RAISING RISKS EARLY

Fresha

A handheld scanner that detects spoilage gases and bacteria to show if food is safe to eat, cutting household waste. Storyboarded, sketched, rendered, with a companion app.



MORE WORK

Range of making



Postura

Arduino wearable that learns good and bad posture from motion data and vibrates to correct it. Colour range tested across bands.



Family signet ring

Researched my parents' places of origin and turned that heritage into the symbol on a hand-made silver ring. Culture as a starting point, the same way Liman and Night Court started.



Product & furniture

Rhino form studies, a rapid-prototyping project and furniture pieces, from concept to physical outcome.



Thank you.

I'd love to bring this way of working to your team.

Murat Kurul

murat338338@gmail.com

+44 7393 558168

muratkurul.com · [linkedin.com/in/murat-kurul](https://www.linkedin.com/in/murat-kurul)